

DAY 1 POULTRY INTERMEDIATE LEVEL

PERFORMANCE & PROFIT AWARENESS

Agri_Empower Poultry "Profit & Precision" Masterclass

1. Performance Management: Beyond "Survival"

Performance management in the intermediate level is about moving from being a "bird keeper" to a "production manager." At the foundation level, we were happy if the birds survived. At the intermediate level, we are only happy if the birds are performing at their maximum genetic potential.

- **Uniformity is Key:** Performance management means ensuring 90% of your birds are the same weight. If you have 50 large birds and 50 small birds, your management is failing. Non-uniformity usually points to inadequate feeder space or poor brooding.
- **The Daily Inspection:** You must walk through your pens at least 3 times a day. You aren't just looking for dead birds; you are listening for "snicking" (respiratory sounds), checking the litter moisture, and watching how birds react to your presence.
- **Environmental Control:** Performance is 30% genetics and 70% environment. Managing the temperature and airflow is the most effective way to ensure the birds put their energy into growth rather than staying warm or cooling down.

2. FCR (The Deep Dive): Your Financial Compass

Feed Conversion Ratio (FCR) is the most important number in poultry farming. It tells you exactly how much feed (in kilograms) it takes to produce 1 kilogram of meat.

- **The Formula:** $\text{Total Feed Consumed (kg)} / \text{Total Live Weight of Birds (kg)} = \text{FCR}$.
- **Why it matters:** If your FCR is 1.6, you are highly efficient. If it is 2.2, you are losing money. A high FCR means:
 - **Feed Wastage:** Birds are scratching feed out of trays onto the floor.
 - **Poor Health:** Birds are eating but using the energy to fight infections instead of growing.
 - **Low Quality Feed:** The feed lacks the necessary amino acids to build muscle.
- **Targeting the "Sweet Spot":** As a manager, your daily goal is to lower the FCR. A difference of just 0.1 in FCR can represent thousands of Naira in profit or loss on a 500-bird scale.

3. Record Keeping: The Farm's Memory

You cannot manage what you do not measure. In the intermediate level, your records must be detailed and daily.

- **The Mortality Log:** Don't just record "1 bird died." Record *why* it died (e.g., "ascites," "pecking," or "sudden death"). This helps you see patterns.
- **The Feed Tracker:** Record every bag opened. This allows you to spot a drop in appetite 24 hours before a disease outbreak becomes visible.
- **The Medication/Vaccination Diary:** Essential for "Antibiotic Stewardship." You must know exactly what drugs were given and when the "Withdrawal Period" ends so you don't sell "poisoned" meat to the public.
- **The Weight Log:** Randomly weigh 10% of your flock every 7 days. This allows you to "Benchmark" your birds against the breeder's manual.

4. Profit Thinking: Transitioning to CEO

A farmer thinks about birds; a CEO thinks about ROI (Return on Investment).

- **The Break-Even Point:** You must know your "Cost of Production" per kg. If it costs you ₦1,800 to produce 1kg of chicken, and the market pays ₦1,750, you are working for free.
- **Value of Time:** Profit thinking includes your labor. If the farm doesn't pay you a salary, it isn't a business; it's a hobby.
- **Opportunity Cost:** Every day a bird stays on the farm past its target market weight, it eats your profit. "Profit thinking" means selling at the right time, not the "biggest" size.